UNIT 2 SEARCHING FOR A JOB

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2.0 OBJECTIVES

By the end of the unit you will:

- have some idea about the world of jobs
- know how to search for a suitable job
- know how to write letters to find out about the job market
- explore the internet for jobs
- understand vocabulary associated with jobs

2.1 WARM UP

Are you familiar with the internet? If so, look up the Internet and find at least three to four sites that will tell you about the availability of jobs.

Interview any young friend who has just secured a job. Find out about his/her job.

2.2 READING COMPREHENSION: CREATIVE JOB HUNTING

A **career** is a course of successive situations that make up some activity. One can have a sporting career or a musical career, but most frequently "career" in the 21st century refers to the workplace: the series of jobs or positions by which one earns one's bread.

In the relatively static societies before modernism, many workers would often inherit or take up a single lifelong position (a place or role) in the workforce, and the concept of an unfolding career had little or no meaning. With new ideas of progress and of the habits of individualist self-betterment, careers became possible, if not expected.

Career counseling is one-on-one or group professional assistance in exploration and decision making tasks related to choosing a major occupation. The field is vast and includes Career Placement, Career Planning, Learning Strategies, and Student Development.

By the late 20th century a plethora of choices (especially in the range of potential professions) and more widespread education had allowed it to become fashionable to plan (or design) a career.

Once you have decided on your career and completed the course of study, you will need to look for a job. In order to decide the sort of job you would like to undertake, it is sometimes advisable to contact consultants who could help you to understand the challenges involved in starting a new job. Consultants that take up too may diverse areas may loose focus and may not be able to deliver the goods. However many consultancies have had real success stories and going to one can help you plan your ventures.

It has been estimated that most jobs are not advertised in a competitive job market. Most employers actually expect applicants to take the initiative. It has been estimated that one-third of vacancies for graduates are not advertised publicly, particularly in a competitive job market. It can be cost effective for the employer to draw on a limited but well-qualified and motivated "self-referred" pool of candidates.

If you decide to take this creative approach to job search, remember that thorough research is vital to success. A small number of well-targeted applications are more likely to produce results than wasting paper and postage on mass mailing.

You will need to look beyond the recruitment sections of the local and national press to the general news/business sections. Where have new contracts been awarded, which organisations are expanding, who is reporting record profits or developing a new product/service?

Research thoroughly. What is the focus of individual companies? What do they look for in graduates?

Build up a network of contacts. Usually people are happy to talk about their areas of work and can provide you with further, perhaps even more relevant contacts. Academic staff may have excellent links with the local industry and commerce, which could help you develop your network.

Remember to keep a record of your network of contacts and follow them up from time to time to let them know you are actively seeking work, to update them on your progress or to say thank-you. Never underestimate the effectiveness of personal contacts – hopefully your motivation and perseverance will be recognised when a vacancy does turn up.

Telephone before you send a letter, so that your application does not arrive "cold" or on the wrong person's desk. Aim to track down the most relevant person and their job title (and make sure you spell their name correctly!). Clearly state what job area you are interested in. Say why you have chosen to apply to that particular organisation. Demonstrate that you know something about them, their products and/or services.

You will need to convince the employer that you can do the job for which you are applying. The style and tone of your letter should be persuasive. State when you are available for an interview or discussion. You may want to follow your letter with a telephone call a few days later to demonstrate your commitment and enthusiasm.

If you want to discuss creative job-hunting or receive feedback about your CV and covering letter, feel free to speak to a Career Adviser or use an E-Guidance service.

Activity 1

After reading the passage answer the following questions.

1) What does a career imply in the 21st Century?

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2) Before the so called 'modernism' what sort of jobs existed?

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3) What is the role of the career counselors or advisors?

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4) List some other areas in which career counselors work?

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5) Besides counselors who are the other people who can help you with a job?

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6) A creative approach to a job implies:

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7) How do you prevent your application from reaching 'cold'?

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2.3 VOCABULARY: DEFINITIONS

Activity 2

1) Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate words.

   i) I have been in this job so long that I feel my career is more or less _____. (progressive, static)

   ii) It is interesting to _____ the possibilities of different career options. (explore, accept)

   iii) It is advisable to take help from _____ to find a job. (consultants, offices)

   iv) Sometimes in the _____ world today jobs are not advertised. (consultant, competitive)

   v) Jobs are advertised in the _____ sections of the newspapers. (matrimonial, recruitment)

2) Look at the adjectives below. Match each of the definitions (i-xii) with one of the adjectives. The first one is done for you.

extrovert	punctual	sensitive	ambitious	practical
cool-headed	empathetic	persuasive	dynamic	reliable
energetic	creative			

Definitions:

i) A person who wants to get to the top. *ambitious*

ii) A person who can relate to other people's feelings.

iii) A person who enjoys meeting people and new situations.

iv) A person who is always on time.

v) A person who can be counted upon.

vi) A person who can change people's opinions.

vii) A person who is good at finding solutions to problems.

viii) A person who is original in his thinking.

ix) A person with the capacity for vigorous activity.

x) A person who is easily affected by emotions.

xi) A person who is forceful and vigorous.

xii) A person who does not easily get ruffled.

2.4 LISTENING

Activity 3

Listen to this advertisement on the audio. Complete the passage after you have listened to the advertisement

The advertisement is for jobs in a)_____ sector. They are looking for b)_____c)_____ experts. For the General Managers the three skills that are desirable are d)_____, e)_____, f)_____. Experience should be a minimum of g)_____ years. For Project Managers the candidate should be h)_____ / _____ or i)_____ with at least j)_____ years of experience. Project leaders should have 6 years of k)_____ experience. Candidates having l)_____ visa will be preferred. Interviews can be scheduled by m)_____ or by sending n)_____ to the enail address given.

2.5 SPEAKING

Activity 4

Here is a situation.

You have gone to submit your application for a job. When you reach there you find that it is a "walk in" interview. You are asked to wait as you will be called in shortly. At the reception you meet another young man / woman. You get into a conversation about your qualifications and your previous job. In pairs act out this scene. Ensure that both of you speak, on issues that are relevant. Before you speak you and your partner can write out your script.

2.6 GRAMMAR: PASSIVE FORM

Read the following sentences from the reading passage:

1) It has been estimated that most jobs are not advertised in a competitive job market.

2) Never underestimate the effectiveness of personal contacts – hopefully your motivation and preferences will be recognized when a vacancy does turn up.

The underlined sentences are in the passive voice and the doers of the action are not mentioned. The doers in reports, newspaper headlines and science experiments are omitted because the doers are many or are not very important to know, or are very obvious.

The passive forms of the verb in different tenses would look as follows:

Tense	Simple	Continuous	Perfect
Present	Is/am/are+ past participle	Is/am/are+ being+ past participle	Has/have+ been +part participle
Past	Was/were+past participle	Was/were + being + past participle	Had + been + past participle
Future	Will/ shall + be + past participle	-	-

Activity 5

Change the following sentences into the passive voice. Omit the doer where it is necessary.

1) They pulled down many trees.

2) We make water from a mixture of hydrogen and oxygen.

3) Someone hit my car from the back.

4) The Principal unfolded the flag on Independence Day.

5) Madam Curie discovered Radium.

6) They announced the winners of the Nobel Prize in Physics and Chemistry yesterday.

7) Someone broke the window yesterday in the evening.

8) The fire brigade will put out the fire.

9) They have cleared all the roads in this area due to VIP movement.

10) They elected a new mayor yesterday.

2.7 WRITING: FILLING UP A QUESTIONNAIRE

Activity 6

Filling up a questionnaire

Very often when you apply for a job you submit a resume. On the basis of the resume you are short listed and called for an interview. Some companies expect you to fill up a questionnaire just before the interview.

Here's such a questionnaire. Please read it carefully and fill it up. You have applied to a company manufacturing chocolates.

Questionnaire

All candidates appearing for the interview are expected to fill up this form just before the interview. This will give us a better picture of you.

Name:

Job applied for. Tick the right box.

Management Trainee	Administrator	Account Officer
☐	☐	☐

a) List previous jobs and positions held if any.

1)

2)

3) Not Applicable

b) List three reasons why you feel you are really suitable for the job.

1)

2)

3)

c) List any two hobbies you have that will support your candidature and say how.

1)

2)

d) These are some qualities we value in our employees. Number them according your priority.

honesty	☐	commitment	☐
punctuality	☐	respect	☐
sense of belonging	☐	responsibility	☐

e) In a short paragraph of not more than 100 words tell us about yourself. Write about your dreams and ambitions and how you plan to make them a reality.

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2.8 LET US SUM UP

After going through this unit you will have some idea of the type of jobs available in the market. More than that, you would have learnt how to explore the job market and get help to find the most suitable job. Remember that if you get a job you like and enjoy it then your job will cease to be work, and will become a world of joy. That would be the best thing that would happen to you, wouldn't it?

2.9 ANSWERS

Activity 1

1) It means a working existence, or a job by which one earns one's living.
2) Before the state of 'modernism' people would inherit or take up a single lifelong job.
3) They assess your interests, personality, values and skills and help you to explore career options.
4) Career placement, career planning, learning strategies and student development.
5) Consultants provide advice on the challenges of new jobs.
6) A creative approach to job implies taking the initiative and
   - Writing a small number of well targeted applications
   - Studying the business section of a newspaper
   - Studying new contacts
   - Building up a network of contacts

7) Telephone the right person before you send the application. Clearly state your job interest, explain why you have chosen to apply and show that you know about the job.

Activity 2

1) i) static
   ii) explore
   iii) consultants
   iv) competitive
   v) recruitment

2) i) ambitions
   ii) empathetic
   iii) extrovert
   iv) punctual
   v) reliable
   vi) persuasive
   vii) practical
   viii) creative
   ix) energetic
   x) sensitive
   xi) dynamic
   xii) cool-headed

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Tape script

This is radio Barkha. Well, it is time now for job advertisements. You may be the lucky one who has a job waiting for you. Best of luck all you job seekers, young and not so young - here we go……

This ad is for those interested in working

It is not for everyone.

It takes a lot to be a banking technology expert. And that's exactly what Fiserv needs. The world's largest IT Company has a market cap of $8 billion and over 17,000 clients. And it's now looking for people under the following heads.

Banking Experts

General Managers: Candidates should be BE/B.Tech / ME / M.Tech/MBA/ CA. Excellent interpersonal, marketing skills and sound technical exposure is required. 11 or more years of experience in handling multiple projects in banking domains. PMP certification will be an added advantage.

Project Managers: Candidates should be BE/B.Tech/ME/M.Tech/ MBA/CA with over 8 years of experience. Excellent interpersonal skills and sound technical exposure is a must. PMP certification will be an added advantage.

Project Leaders: Candidates should be BE/B.Tech / ME / M.Tech/MBA/CA with over 6 years of experience. Hands on exposure to the given technologies is essential.

Candidates with B1 Visa would be preferred. Interested candidates may call at 91-9818327119 to get an interview scheduled or send their resumes to careers@fiserv.co.in

Activity 3

a) the banking sector

b) banking

c) technology

d) interpersonal skills

e) marketing skills

f) sound technical exposure

g) 11 eleven

h) B.E /B.Tech or

i) MBA/M.Tech / CA

j) 8 (eight)

k) hands on experience

l) B1

m) telephone

n) resume

Activity 4

Omar: Hi! My name is Omar. Are you waiting for the interview for the script writer for the radio station?

Surayia: I'm Surayia. Yes, although I didn't realize that this is going to be a "walk in" interview. I haven't really prepared.

Omar: Well, nor have I. I thought that we just have to submit the application.

Surayia: Well, is this your first job?

Omar: No, actually I have done a short stint with ARBC.

Surayia: Wow! Why did you leave?

Omar: Oh, it was a project for four months. What about you?

Surayia: This would be my first job, although I have done some script writing as part of my training.

Omar: Where were you trained?

Surayia: At the College of Mass Communication.

Omar: That's a really fine place.

Surayia: Where were you trained?

Omar: Oh, at a local vocational institute.

Surayia: Oh that's my name announced—see you.

Activity 5

1) Many trees were pulled down.
2) Water is made from a mixture of hydrogen and oxygen.
3) My car was hit from the back.
4) The flag was unfolded by the Principal on Independence Day.
5) Radium was discovered by Madam Curie.
6) The winners of the Nobel Prize in Physics and Chemistry were announced yesterday.
7) The window was broken yesterday in the evening.
8) The fire will be put out by the fire brigade.
9) All the roads in the area have been cleared due to the movement of VIP.
10) A new mayor was elected yesterday.

Activity 6

My name is Salmaan Anwar. I'm in my final year of Economics (Major). I have many dreams which I'm determined to fulfill. I wish to join UNESCO. Here I would like to work on projects involving underprivileged children. My dream is to create a world where no child goes hungry. My greatest joy is to see a smile on a child's face. In order to fulfill my ambition I am also a member of the college social welfare club. We have taken under our care a nearby slum cluster. I do voluntary teaching there. I teach both adults and children. I go there twice a week in the evenings.

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